CBSE Class 10 Political Science Notes Chapter - 7 Outcomes Of Democracy

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BASIC CONCEPTS

- **Democracy**

  Democracy was better because it:

  (i) Promotes equality among citizens;

  (ii) Enhances the dignity of the individual;

  (iii) Improves the quality of decision making;

  (iv) Provides a method to resolve conflicts; and

  (v) Allows room to correct mistakes.

- **Democracy. Accountable, responsive and Legitimate government**

In a democracy, we are most concerned with ensuring that people will have the right to choose their rulers and people will have control over the rulers.

(i) The most basic outcome of democracy should be that it produces a government that is accountable to the citizens, and responsive to the needs and expectations of the citizens.

(ii) Democracy is based on the idea of deliberation and negotiation. So, some delay is bound totake place.

(iii) It may take decisions that are not accepted by the people and may therefore face problems.In contrast, the democratic government will take more time to follow procedures before arriving at a decision. But because it has followed procedures, its decisions may be both more acceptable to the people and more effective. So, the cost of time that democracy paysis perhaps worth it.

(iv) Right and the means to examine the process of decision making. This is known as transparency This factor is often missing from a non-democratic government.

(v) To measure democracies on the basis of this expected outcome, you would look for the following practices and institutions: regular, free and fair elections, open public debate on major policies and legislations, and citizens' right to information about the government andits functioning.

(vi) Democracy's ability to generate its own support is itself an outcome that cannot be ignored.

- **Inequality and Poverty**

(i) Democracies are based on political equality. All individuals have equal right in electing representatives. Parallel to the process of bringing individuals into the political arena on an equal footing, we find growing economic inequalities.

(ii) The poor constitute a large proportion of our voters and no party will like to lose their votes. Yet democratically elected governments do not appear to be as keen to address the question of poverty as you would expect them to.

- **Accommodation of Social Diversity**

(i) No society can fully and permanently resolve conflicts among different groups. But we can certainly learn to respect these differences and we can also evolve mechanisms to negotiate the differences.

(ii) Democracy is best suited to produce this outcome. Non-democratic regimes often turn a blind eye to or suppress internal social differences.

(iii) A democracy must fulfil two conditions in order to achieve this outcome:

(a) It is necessary to understand that democracy is not simply ruled by majority opinion. The majority always needs to work with the minority so that governments function to represent the general view. Majority and minority opinions are not permanent.

(b) It is also necessary that rule by majority does not become rule by majority community interms of religion or race or linguistic group, etc. Rule by majority means that in case of every decision or in case of every election, different persons and groups may and can form a majority

- **Dignity and Freedom of the Citizens**

(i) Democracy stands much superior to any other form of government in promoting dignity and freedom of the individual.

(ii) Every individual wants to receive respect from fellow beings. Often conflicts arise among individuals because some feel that they are not treated with due respect.

(iii) The passion for respect and freedom are the basis of democracy. Democracies throughout the world have recognised this, at least in principle. This has been achieved in various degrees invarious democracies.

(iv) Long struggles by women have created some sensitivity today that respect to and equal treatment of women are necessary ingredients of a democratic society.

(v) But once the principle is recognised, it becomes easier for women to wage a struggle against what is now unacceptable legally and morally.

(vi) Democracy in India has strengthened the claims of the disadvantaged and discriminated castes for equal status and equal opportunity. There are instances still of caste-based inequalities and atrocities, but these lack the moral and legal foundations. Perhaps it is the recognition that makes ordinary citizens value their democratic rights.

IMPORTANT TERMS

- **Democracy:** A system in which the government of a country is elected by the people.
- Accountable required or expected to justify actions or decisions; responsible.

- **Legitimate Government:** A government generally acknowledged as being in control of a nation and deserving formal recognition, which is symbolized by the exchange of diplomats between that government and the governments of other countries.
- **Deliberation:** Long and careful discussion.
- **Negotiation:** Discussion aimed at reaching an agreement.
- **Dictator:**A ruler with total power over a country, typically one, who has obtained control by force.
- **Disparities:**A great difference.
- Social Diversity People with different opinions, backgrounds (degrees and social experience), religious beliefs, political beliefs, sexual orientations, heritage, and life experience.
- **Majority:** A great number.
- **Minority:** The smaller number or part, especially a number or part representing less than half of the whole.
- **Dignity:** The state or quality of being worthy of honour or respect.
- **Atrocity:**An extremely wicked or cruel act, typically one involving physical violence or injury.

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